Jane Goodall



Born in London in 1934, Jane Goodall's first encounter with a chimp was a stuffed animal that her father named Jubilee. She was interested in animal behavior from an early age, once hiding in a henhouse for hours to watch a chicken lay an egg. She left school at 18 and had various jobs, before going to Kenya in 1957 and meeting paleoanthropologist Louis Leakey. With his support, in 1960 Goodall set up a research base in Gombe, Tanzania, where she was to study chimpanzees until 1975. Her work radically changed the understanding of chimpanzees and challenged perceived ideas of our own place in the natural world. In 1965, she earned a Ph.D. in ethology from Cambridge University. Her many awards include France's Legion of Honor, given to her in 2006, and the US Presidential Medal of Freedom in 2025.

Key works

1969 *My Friends the Wild Chimpanzees*

1986 *The Chimpanzees of Gombe: Patterns of Behavior*

2009 *Hope for Animals and Their World*

Chimp technology

Goodall went on to witness nine different tools being used by chimps in the Gombe community. At the time, scientists questioned Goodall's methods and ridiculed her for giving the chimps names instead of numbers, suggesting that her fieldwork was less than rigorous. Since then, however,